City of London Corporation Committee Report

Committee(s): Hampstead Heath Consultative Committee Hampstead Heath, Highgate Wood and Queen's Park Committee	**Dated:** 21 April 2026 12 May 2026
Subject: Report of Action Taken	**Public report:** For Information
This proposal: • **provides statutory duties** • **provides business enabling functions**	
Does this proposal require extra revenue and/or capital spending?	N/A
If so, how much?	N/A
What is the source of Funding?	N/A
Has this Funding Source been agreed with the Chamberlain's Department?	N/A
Report of:	Ian Thomas CBE, Town Clerk & Chief Executive
Report author:	Zoe Williams, Governance Officer

Summary

This report provides details of decisions taken under urgency procedures, in consultation with the Chairman and Deputy Chairman in accordance with Standing Order 40(a) since the last meeting.

Recommendation

Members are asked to:

- Note the action taken since the last meeting of the Hampstead Heath, Highgate Wood and Queen's Park Committee.

Decisions taken under Urgency under Standing Order 40(a)

Hampstead Heath Fees and Charges for Financial Year 2026-27

Background:

1. As this meeting of the Hampstead Heath, Highgate Wood, and Queen's Park Committee was scheduled for after the start of the financial year, a report with the proposed fees and charges was submitted to the Town Clerk for approval via the City Corporation's urgency procedure, in consultation with the Hampstead Heath Consultative Committee, the Hampstead Heath, Highgate Wood and Queen's Park Committee, and the Chairman and Deputy Chairman.
2. Representations from the Hampstead Heath Sports and Wellbeing Forum, the Hampstead Heath Consultative Committee and the Hampstead Heath, Highgate Wood and Queen's Park Committee, along with Officer's responses, can be found in the background report.
3. On this occasion, due to the approval timeframe coinciding with bank holidays and time needed to update and check relevant booking systems, websites, signage, and other places where fees and charges are communicated, the fees were implemented on 8 April 2026.
4. During the consultation process, Officers noticed some minor rounding errors in Appendix 1 where rounding conventions were not accurately applied. Appendix 1 of the background report which was submitted to the Town Clerk included the updated amounts with the appropriate rounding conventions applied. These corrections did not involve any substantial amounts, as all were under £0.50.
5. It was proposed that for the 2026-27 financial year, the majority of fees and charges were increased by 4.5%. This aligned with the 12-month September 2025 SPI inflation rate as reported by the Officers of National Statistics, with limited exceptions noted in Appendix 1 of the background report.
6. Officers undertook benchmarking exercises to ensure charges remained in line with local providers (as outlined in Appendix 2 of the background report), and the proposed fees and charges continued to include concessionary rates, offering a 40% discount on the standard adult charge.
7. Further changes to the 2026-27 fees and charges were identified in the background report as follows. Information on these changes can be found in the background report.
    a. It was proposed that the fee for the angling season permit be increased to a modernised fee of £50 on a two-year phased basis, beginning with an increase to £30 in financial year 2026-27.
    b. The majority of swimming ticket prices were recommended to rise in line with inflation. However, the combined 12-month Lido-and-ponds season ticket would now provide a 15% discount from the combined cost of purchasing the two annual passes separately. This was a reduction from the current 30% discount. The discount was proposed to bring this season ticket in line with individual session charges and individual season tickets whilst still offering good value for money for regular swimmers.
    c. Entry to the sauna was proposed to increase from £5 to £7.

d. Season ticket prices for the Parliament Hill track were recommended to rise above the rate of inflation to ensure better alignment between season and individual ticket prices and to benchmark more closely with similar facilities. A phased increase was proposed, with the adult 12-month season ticket rising to £150 in 2026–27, then to £200 in 2027-28. Individual session tickets and track hire fess for club and school bookings were proposed to be increased in line with inflation.

e. It was also recommended that Hampstead Heath cease accepting cash payments from 1 June 2026, due to the unnecessary risks and costs associated with handling cash, as outlined in the background report.

f. Officers also sought approval to institute an initial fee of £100 per person for a proposed three-day 'Junior Keeper Club' pilot programme which would allow a small group of children to learn about becoming a Zookeeper and to take part in a series of activities that focus on the key areas of working in a zoo. This fee had been established following benchmarking to other similar and established programmes.

Decision taken:

Following consultation with the Chairman and Deputy Chairman of the Hampstead Heath, Highgate Wood and Queen's Park Committee, the Town Clerk:

a. Approved the proposed fees and charges for 2026-27, as set out in appendix 1 of the background report.

Background Papers

- Hampstead Heath Fees and Charges FY'2026-27 (1 April 2026 – 31 March 2027)
- Appendix 1 – Fees and charges (FY'2026-2027) - Hampstead Heath
- Appendix 2 – Benchmarking 2026 – Hampstead Heath

Copies of the background papers concerning this decision are available from Zoe Williams on request.

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